The biggest crypto heist in history.

The Binance hack, hour by hour: **how it was possible and where the money went.**

⚠ critical incident

Swipe →

Sources: Binance, Elliptic, Arkham, FBI.

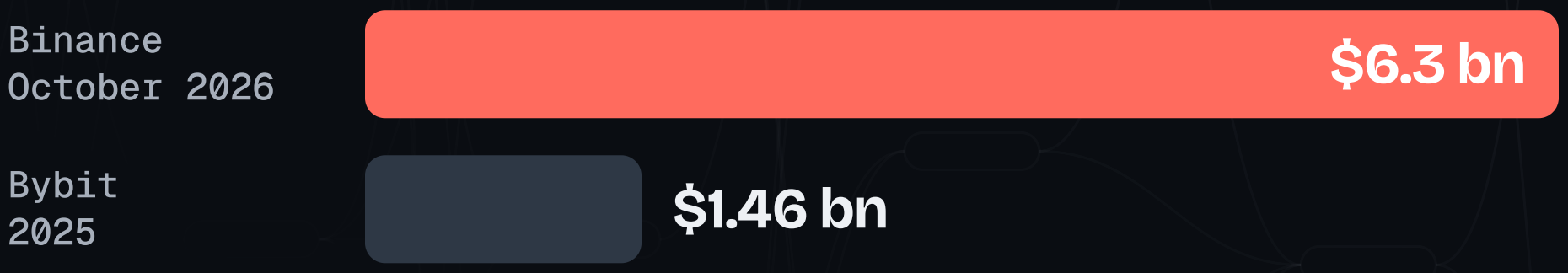
TC

Teodoro Corbo

updated 2 November 2026

6.3

billion dollars in one evening



> “Almost certainly the largest single theft of any kind in history.”
>
> Elliptic

Sources: Binance (impact estimate), Elliptic. Bars as long as the value stolen.

15 minutes to take $4.9 billion.

- **20:05** — **First unauthorized withdrawals** from Binance hot wallets.
- **20:24** — **$2.53 billion** leaves in a single transaction.
- **20:41** — A second wallet drained: **$780 million** in USDC.
- **21:01** — **Tether freezes** the first stolen funds.
- **23:05** — Last wave, on Avalanche and Polygon.

Sources: Arkham, Elliptic, TRM Labs, Etherscan.

TC
Teodoro Corbo
Binance hack

They didn't steal the key. They took over the stamp office.

The withdrawal request

Prepared by the attacker.

The stamp office

Binance's system that signs withdrawals.

in the attacker's hands

The stamp is valid

The request comes out signed like all the others.

The blockchain accepts

It checks the stamp, not who put it there.

~~Key theft~~: no evidence, says Binance.

Sources: TRM Labs, Blockaid, Elliptic; Binance.

50 signatures. Only one valid.

On Ethereum a single signed authorization is enough to hand a wallet over to a contract. But it only works with the wallet's exact sequence number, and Binance 14 went through thousands an hour.

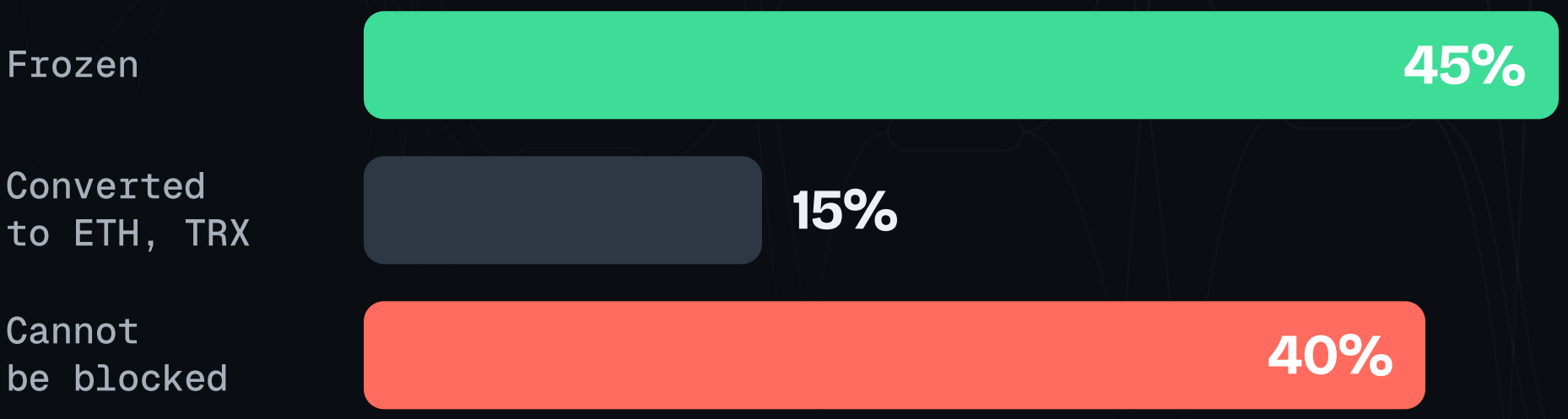
So the attacker had **50 signed, with 50 consecutive numbers**. One hit the mark: 3 minutes and 24 seconds later came the 20:24 withdrawal.

Sources: on-chain data (Etherscan), Blockaid.

TC
Teodoro Corbo
Binance hack

3.5

billion left with the attacker, out of 6.3



Based on Arkham data, values at the time of the theft. Sources: Elliptic, TRM Labs.

What's in, what's missing.

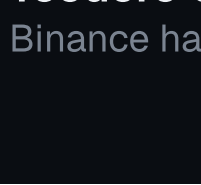
31/10 attributed by the FBI

The FBI attributes the theft to **TraderTraitor** (North Korea). In 2 days; for Bybit, 5.

31/10 claimed by Binance

The reserves snapshot adds up.

31/10 claimed by Binance



of the losses covered with Binance's own funds.

1/11 claimed by Binance

Withdrawals reopened: **$4.65 billion** out in 9½ hours.

as of 2 November

? **The technical details**

promised “within 48 hours”

? **The cryptographic check of the reserves**

? **The post-mortem**

Sources: FBI Cyber Branch on X (31/10); Binance on X (1/11), Update #3 and proof of reserves (31/10).

TC **Teodoro Corbo**
Binance hack

Control who signs, control the funds.



People and processes around the signatures

gave way

Cryptography

held

Only what has an issuer can be blocked: for everything else, speed counts.

✓ USDT: frozen by Tether

⚠ BTC and ETH: no one can block them

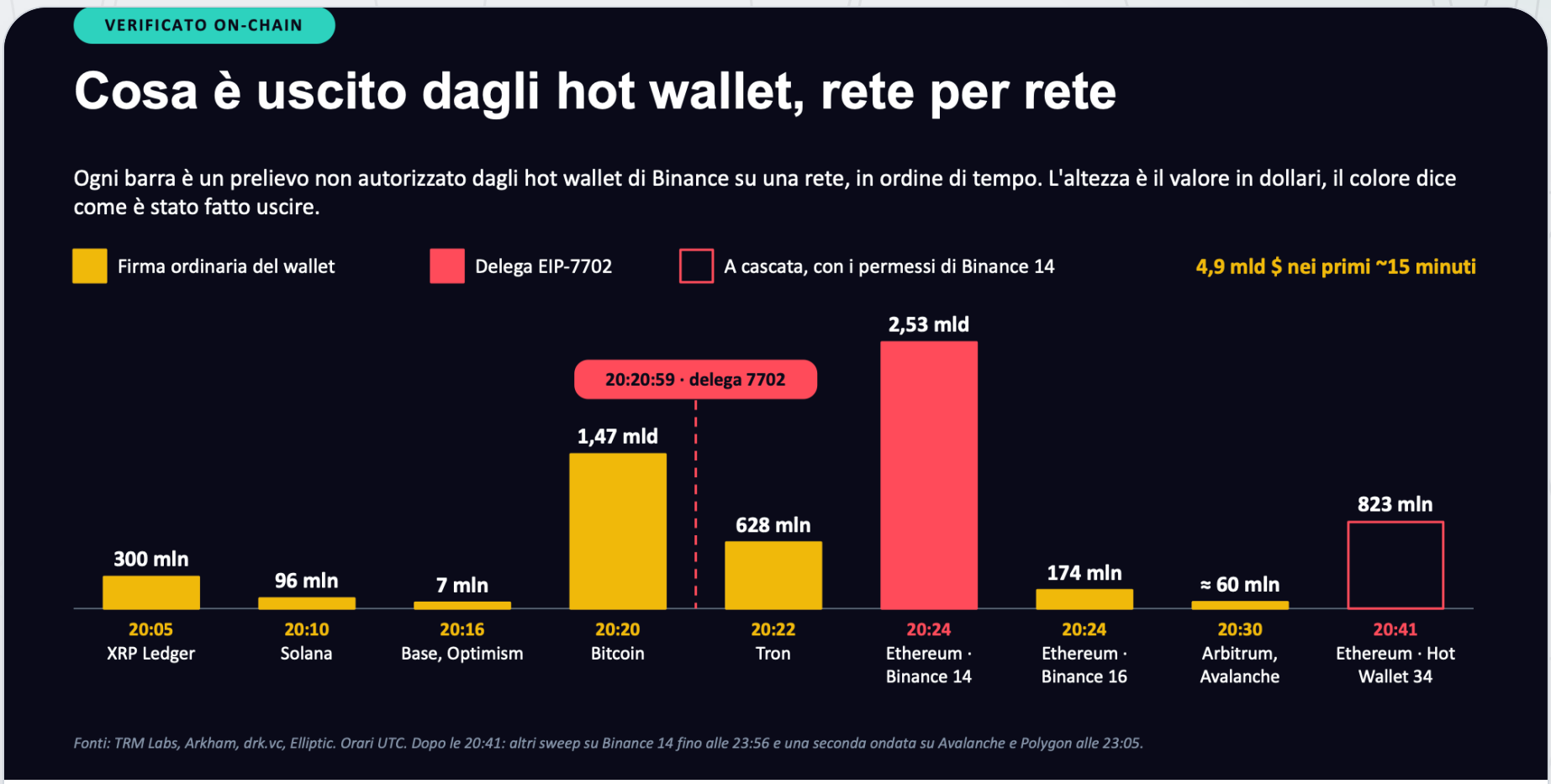
The author's analysis of the sources in the previous slides.

TC

Teodoro Corbo

Binance hack

That was the short version.



The biggest crypto heist in history: the Binance hack

↗ teodoro98.github.io/en/analysis/binance-hack

The full analysis, with all the sources: link in the first comment.

If something doesn't add up, comment below or send me a DM.

TC

Teodoro Corbo
AWS Solutions Architect